

The Startup Launch Checklist

Every step from idea to launch day — in the order that actually works.

Part of the free Founder Launch Pack — yours to keep, share, and act on. No strings, no lead farming.

Phase 1 — Validate the Idea

Before you spend money, prove someone wants this.

- Write a one-sentence description of the problem and who has it
- Interview 10 people who match your target customer
- Research existing competitors (competition signals demand)
- Put up a simple landing page and measure email sign-ups
- Define your single riskiest assumption and test it cheaply

Phase 2 — Lock In Your Identity

- Brainstorm 15–20 short, easy-to-spell name candidates
- Check domain availability and compare prices across registrars
- Compare first-year price AND renewal price before buying
- Secure matching social handles
- Create a simple logo and choose two brand colours

Phase 3 — Build Your Home Base

- Choose a website builder matched to your model (store vs content vs portfolio)
- Set up your domain and connect it to your site
- Write clear homepage copy: who it's for, what it does, why it's better
- Add an email capture / waitlist form
- Set up basic analytics

Phase 4 — Set Up the Money

- Open a dedicated business bank account before your first sale
- Choose accounting software and connect your bank feed
- Understand your basic tax obligations for your country & structure
- Set up a simple system to store receipts and invoices
- Decide your pricing and how you'll take payment

Phase 5 — Prepare to Launch

- Build a small waitlist and warm it up with updates
- Prepare launch-day assets: announcement post, email, demo
- Line up a handful of friendly early users for fast feedback
- Pick ONE marketing channel to go deep on
- Set a launch date and tell people about it

Next step: Let the Igotdomain AI assistant turn this checklist into a live roadmap with a Business Launch Score — free at igotdomain.com.